

Constitution of PHOKUS
Furman University
(Last Updated July 2023)

I. Name

The organization will be called PHOKUS, standing for Promoting Healthy Options through Knowledge, Understanding, and Service.

II. Purpose/Mission

The purpose of PHOKUS will be to serve as an education resource for students to assist in making healthy life decisions. The specific goals of PHOKUS will be to:

- A. Educate on the risk of destructive decisions for college students.
- B. Provide the student body with the best prevention and intervention tools regarding health related matters.
- C. Raise awareness for different health related matters.

III. Membership

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation. Membership is open to all FU students who want to take a proactive role in being a peer educator and who have an interest in public and personal health and wellness.

Responsibilities:

- A. Attend all meetings and PHOKUS sponsored events
 - a. If a member is unable to attend a meeting or an event, he/she is required to clear the absence with the officers beforehand except in cases of emergency.
- B. PHOKUS members are expected to follow through with any and all commitments made.
- C. Assist in campaigns and programming that will help educate students to make healthy decisions.
- D. Serve as a representative of Furman University by being aware of the decisions faced every day by college students and representing PHOKUS well.
- E. PHOKUS members that continually do not abide by the Membership Responsibilities are eligible for sanctions

Expectations:

- A. Attend all weekly meetings taking place in Furman Hall room 209. Notifications about changes in the meeting schedule will be given at least 2 days in advance via email.
- B. **Be on time:** if you need to arrive late or leave early, you must notify an officer via email/text at least 24 hours prior to the meeting. If prior notification cannot be given (i.e. in an emergency), leniency will be left to the discretion of the advisor and officers. Without notification, on multiple occasions, you must meet one-on-one with the officers.

- C. **Absences:** allowed 2 per semester. An officer must be notified via email at least 24 hours prior to the meeting. Absences without prior notification will be marked as unexcused but will be discussed in the weekly Officers Meeting and potentially re-identified as excused/unexcused.

Attend and Support PHOKUS

- A. All PHOKUS members are expected to volunteer their time to benefit the organization. Volunteer activities can be spread across tabling events, CLP organizing, community service, health programming, and other activities
- B. Each member is expected to sign up for at least one portion of each event (promotion, organization, attendance at event). If you cannot attend the event, please sign up for promotional activities (banner painting/hanging, chalking, flier making, flier distribution, etc).
- C. Academics and your health come first: Communicate with an officer if an extreme circumstance prevents you from attending a shift that you have signed up to volunteer for.
 - a. Academic absences - permission for an absence due to academic reason must be requested at least 2 days (48 hours) prior to the activity. However, it is your responsibility to find a replacement for your shift position!
 - b. Health absences - permission for an absence due to health reasons must be requested as soon as you know you will be unable to volunteer. If you think you are sick, please let us know and find a replacement as soon as possible.

Represent PHOKUS respectfully and professionally

- A. PHOKUS members should wear PHOKUS attire when volunteering at an activity.
- B. Remember, you are not a counselor: Refer students to campus resources as required, and do not attempt to diagnose a student. See additional information in your PHOKUS resources for referring students to Student Health Services or Student Counseling Services.
- C. Be a good role model: Posts on Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Snapchat, etc. in reference to PHOKUS must be respectful and positive. Posts by you in general should not be in conflict with the mission and vision of the Student Health Services and PHOKUS. Your profiles and posts should reflect positive health behaviors and promote the lifestyle you are educating students on.
- D. At PHOKUS events: Engage students in programs and activities actively and consistently. Speak about positive health behaviors, rather than berate negative health behaviors.

Contribute new ideas, opinions, and suggestions.

- A. Communicate with advisor and officers any ideas you have on any of the health topics we cover in PHOKUS.
- B. If you have a new idea: share it!
- C. Submit suggestions anonymously at meetings or to the advisor/officers via email or in person.

IV. Officers

- A. The members of PHOKUS will elect offices of President, Vice President, and Secretary, all of whom are current students at Furman University. PHOKUS is advised by a faculty or staff member of Furman University who will retain the title of PHOKUS advisor. If it is felt necessary to add/change any positions when election time comes, description will be made by the current officers.
- B. The officers will provide leadership within PHOKUS and work closely with the PHOKUS advisor.
- C. Officers will foster positive relationships among ALL PHOKUS members.

Officer qualifications:

- D. Be a current Furman University student.
- E. Regularly attend scheduled meetings and events (be in good attendance standing).
- F. Promote/ participate in all PHOKUS events.
- G. Serve on committees when asked.
- H. Be a role model to other PHOKUS members, leading by example.

Officer Duties

- A. President:
 - a. Coordinate PHOKUS members for event planning to ensure organization's success.
 - b. Assist in the planning and organization of all PHOKUS events.
 - c. Attend and lead all PHOKUS meetings.
 - d. Meet regularly with PHOKUS advisor.
 - e. Help recruit new PHOKUS members.
 - f. Serve on the Pre-Health Student Group Council (or elect a representative to serve).
 - g. Attend all PHOKUS officer's meetings.
 - h. Maintain the SyncDIN calendar of events.
 - i. Reserve rooms as needed via 25Live.
- B. Vice President:
 - a. Assist in the planning and organization of all PHOKUS events.
 - b. Assist in coordinating PHOKUS members for event planning to ensure organization's success.
 - c. Help recruit new PHOKUS members.
 - d. Attend and assist in leading all PHOKUS meetings.
 - e. Meet regularly with PHOKUS advisor.
 - f. Oversee all committees and establish a communication system between the committees and the organization as a whole.
 - g. Attend all PHOKUS officer meetings.
- C. Secretary:

- a. Organization's main source of communication.
- b. Ensures meetings are effectively organized and recorded.
- c. Takes attendance at all events including weekly meetings, tabling events, volunteer events, and all other PHOKUS related events.
- d. Help recruit new PHOKUS members.
- e. Control funds in PHOKUS SGA account (authorized to sign documents which serves as acknowledgement of his/her responsibility to ensure the balance remains at a positive cash balance).
- f. Present budget items at PHOKUS meetings.
- g. Attend all PHOKUS officer meetings

Elections:

All active members of PHOKUS, including officers (not including the advisor), will have voting privileges.

- A. The elected positions shall be decided upon via open vote by a simple majority vote of active members.
- B. The election takes place at the end of the academic year, at least one month prior to the last day of class to ensure a proper transitional phase.
- C. There no limit to the number of nominees per position.
- D. At least one month prior to the election, the club must be given notice of the upcoming election and provided descriptions for each available officer position.
- E. All officer positions are to be voted on during elections, no exceptions.
- F. The year prior's co-president has the first opportunity to continue in that position, with one other co-president being elected to serve alongside him/her. If the former co-president does not wish to continue his/her duties as co-president or is removed from his/her position, two co-presidents will be elected.
- G. After elections conclude, both incoming and outgoing officers for each position must attend the weekly officer's meetings until the end of the academic year.
- H. Upon completion of a full term any past president of PHOKUS shall retain the title of Executive Advisor up to the point of his/her graduation from Furman University.

Removals and resignations:

Removal of a PHOKUS officer from his/her position is a serious step and should be taken only after certifying the accusations and having an in-depth discussion among all concerned. If the person violates the requirements and expectations of a PHOKUS officer, the officer shall be removed from the officer position, not PHOKUS as a whole. Contacting the Student Government Association can assist the club in making this decision/transition, and they can also assist in reporting behavior to the Student Conduct Board, if necessary. If the person removed is the president, another officer or advisor shall run the meeting. The presiding person shall ensure that all discussions are respectful and constructive, maintaining privacy and confidentiality. If an officer resigns or is removed during the school year, the advisor and remaining officers shall appoint a replacement to complete the remainder of the predecessor's term. It is

recommended that the resigning officer give the PHOKUS advisor and fellow officers at least one week's notice.

Process of removal:

- A. PHOKUS member shall make a motion in an officers meeting to remove a person from his/her leadership position and provide the reasons (facts) behind the motion.
- B. A second PHOKUS member needs to make the same motion.
- C. Rebuttal (in person or via written statement) from the person being removed.
- D. Discussion on the situation and the matter at hand shall proceed with all officers and members actively participating. The officer in question shall be removed from the room during this time.
- E. To be removed, there needs to be a $\frac{3}{4}$ majority vote (75%).

Emergency Action

Members will take on emergency action, if necessary, on business brought before PHOKUS in the event a response to such business is needed before the next meeting of the entire organization. Each member must be contacted and informed of the response to such business before the response can be finalized.

V. Advisor

The duties of the advisor are as follows:

- A. Must be present at all meetings.
- B. Must meet with officers monthly to discuss the budget and any upcoming events.
- C. Must work with members to contact speakers and bring in innovative programs each year.
- D. Must attend the Annual National BACCHUS Conference.

Grounds for the removal of an advisor are as follows:

- A. If the advisor does not uphold the standards of PHOKUS.
- B. If the advisor breaks the University Code of Conduct in any way.
- C. If the advisor does not actively take a role in the club.

VI. Finances

PHOKUS will receive funding from SGA. No membership fees will be required. All other acquired funds will be from department sponsors or Student Life to promote the health of students on Furman's campus.

VII. Amendments

Proposed amendments must be presented to the PHOKUS officers in writing. The amendment shall be discussed and then tabled until the next regularly scheduled meeting, during which time the officers will seek the opinion of PHOKUS members. Members shall vote on the amendment. A simple majority vote is required to ratify the amendment (51%).